

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 1

Group 1 Vocabulary

1. Abound

Meaning: To exist in large numbers; to be plentiful.

Tip to remember: Think of “a boundless amount.” If something abounds, there is a lot of it.

Sentence: Opportunities abound for students who work hard.

2. Amorphous

Meaning: Having no clear shape, form, or structure.

Tip to remember: “A” means no, and “morph” means shape. So amorphous means no fixed shape.

Sentence: The cloud had an amorphous shape that kept changing.

3. Austere

Meaning: Simple, plain, strict, or severe.

Tip to remember: Think of a monk’s room: plain, simple, and without luxury. That is austere.

Sentence: The professor lived an austere life with very few possessions.

4. Belie

Meaning: To give a false impression of something; to contradict.

Tip to remember: Belie sounds like “be lie.” Something that belies the truth makes the situation look like a lie.

Sentence: His calm face belied the nervousness he felt inside.

5. Capricious

Meaning: Changing suddenly and unpredictably.

Tip to remember: Think of a “capricious cat” that suddenly changes mood for no reason.

Sentence: The weather in the mountains is often capricious.

6. Cerebral

Meaning: Related to the brain or intellect; thoughtful rather than emotional.

Tip to remember: Cerebral comes from cerebrum, the thinking part of the brain.

Sentence: The movie was very cerebral and required deep thinking.

7. **Congenial**
Meaning: Pleasant, friendly, and suitable.
Tip to remember: Think of a “genial” person who is warm and friendly. Congenial also means friendly.
Sentence: She found the hostel environment congenial and welcoming.
8. **Conspicuous**
Meaning: Easily seen or noticed.
Tip to remember: Think of something that is so obvious that everyone can “see” it.
Sentence: His bright red jacket was conspicuous in the crowd.
9. **Cursory**
Meaning: Quick and not detailed.
Tip to remember: Cursory sounds like “course-run.” You just run through something quickly.
Sentence: He gave the report a cursory glance before the meeting.
10. **Daunting**
Meaning: Intimidating or difficult to deal with.
Tip to remember: Think of a huge mountain before you. Climbing it feels daunting.
Sentence: Preparing for the GRE can seem daunting at first.
11. **Deify**
Meaning: To treat or worship someone as a god.
Tip to remember: “Dei” relates to god, as in deity. Deify means to make someone god-like.
Sentence: Some fans deify their favorite celebrities.
12. **Didactic**
Meaning: Intended to teach, often in a moral or serious way.
Tip to remember: Think of a teacher giving a direct lesson. Didactic writing teaches something.
Sentence: The story was didactic because it taught children the value of honesty.
13. **Disseminate**
Meaning: To spread information widely.
Tip to remember: Think of seeds being spread in a field. Information can also be disseminated.
Sentence: The organization used social media to disseminate important news.
14. **Feasible**
Meaning: Possible and practical to do.
Tip to remember: Feasible sounds like “easy to face.” If you can face it, it is doable.
Sentence: The plan is feasible if we get enough funding.
15. **Flout**
Meaning: To openly ignore or disobey a rule.

Tip to remember: Flout sounds like “flaunt.” If someone flouts rules, they disobey them openly.

Sentence: The company was fined for flouting safety regulations.

16. **Homogeneous**

Meaning: Made up of similar or identical parts.

Tip to remember: “Homo” means same. Homogeneous means same throughout.

Sentence: The classroom was not homogeneous because students came from many backgrounds.

17. **Humdrum**

Meaning: Boring, dull, and ordinary.

Tip to remember: Think of the dull sound “hum-drum” repeating again and again.

Sentence: He wanted to escape his humdrum daily routine.

18. **Insipid**

Meaning: Dull, boring, or lacking flavor.

Tip to remember: Think of soup with no salt. It is tasteless and insipid.

Sentence: The lecture was so insipid that many students lost interest.

19. **Loquacious**

Meaning: Very talkative.

Tip to remember: “Loq” relates to speaking, like eloquent. Loquacious means someone who talks a lot.

Sentence: My loquacious friend can talk for hours without stopping.

20. **Misanthropic**

Meaning: Disliking people or society.

Tip to remember: “Mis” means hatred, and “anthro” means human. Misanthropic means hating people.

Sentence: The misanthropic old man avoided social gatherings.

21. **Misnomer**

Meaning: A wrong or inaccurate name.

Tip to remember: “Mis” means wrong, and “nomer” relates to name. Misnomer means wrong name.

Sentence: Calling the small hill a mountain is a misnomer.

22. **Negligent**

Meaning: Careless; failing to give proper attention.

Tip to remember: Think of neglect. A negligent person neglects responsibilities.

Sentence: The driver was negligent and caused an accident.

23. **Obsequious**

Meaning: Too eager to please or obey someone important.

Tip to remember: Think of a person who says “yes sir, yes sir” too much to impress a boss.

Sentence: His obsequious behavior annoyed his coworkers.

24. **Placate**
Meaning: To calm someone down; to make someone less angry.
Tip to remember: Placate sounds like “place a cake.” Giving cake to an angry person may calm them down.
Sentence: The manager tried to placate the angry customer.
25. **Proclivity**
Meaning: A natural tendency or inclination.
Tip to remember: Think of “pro-climb.” If you naturally climb toward something, you have a proclivity for it.
Sentence: He has a proclivity for solving mathematical problems.
26. **Puerile**
Meaning: Childish or immature.
Tip to remember: Puerile sounds like “pure child.” It means behaving like a child.
Sentence: The students laughed at the puerile joke.
27. **Quixotic**
Meaning: Extremely idealistic and unrealistic.
Tip to remember: From Don Quixote, who fought imaginary enemies. Quixotic plans are noble but unrealistic.
Sentence: His quixotic dream of ending poverty overnight was impossible.
28. **Spendthrift**
Meaning: A person who wastes money.
Tip to remember: The word itself says “spend.” A spendthrift spends too much.
Sentence: A spendthrift must learn to manage money carefully.
29. **Taciturn**
Meaning: Quiet and not talkative.
Tip to remember: Think of “tacit,” meaning silent or understood without words. Taciturn people speak very little.
Sentence: The taciturn student rarely spoke in class.
30. **Wary**
Meaning: Careful or cautious because of possible danger.
Tip to remember: Wary sounds like “worry.” If you are wary, you are careful because you are worried.
Sentence: She was wary of strangers offering help.